

Leadership?

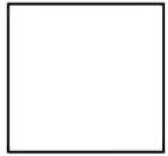
Getting to know yourself, those around you, and working together
(A light introduction!)

Overview

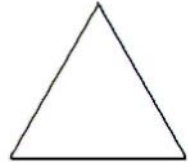
- Pre-work: how to understand myself and others?
- Discussion: what can we really know and understand?
- Pre-work: what makes a “good” or “bad” leader?
- Discussion: what are some key leadership traits?
- Discussion: what is leadership meant to achieve?
- Discussion: what is leadership like in practice?
- Wrap-up: how to “be” and “work” best for myself and others

How to understand myself and others?

Which do you like best and why?



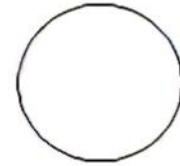
BOX



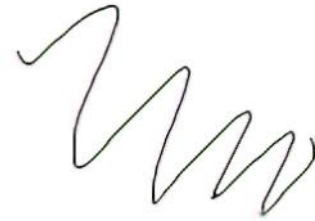
TRIANGLE



RECTANGLE



CIRCLE

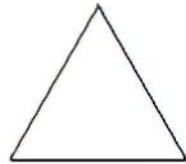


SQUIGGLE

Which do you like best and why?



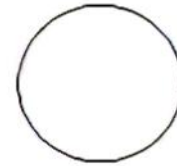
BOX



TRIANGLE



RECTANGLE



CIRCLE



SQUIGGLE

Do the indicators correlate with your personal style?

BOX

Organized
Detailed
Knowledgeable
Analytical
Patient
Persevering

TRIANGLE

Leader
Focused
Decisive
Ambitious
Competitive
Bottom-line

RECTANGLE

In Transition
Courageous
Searching
Inquisitive
Growing

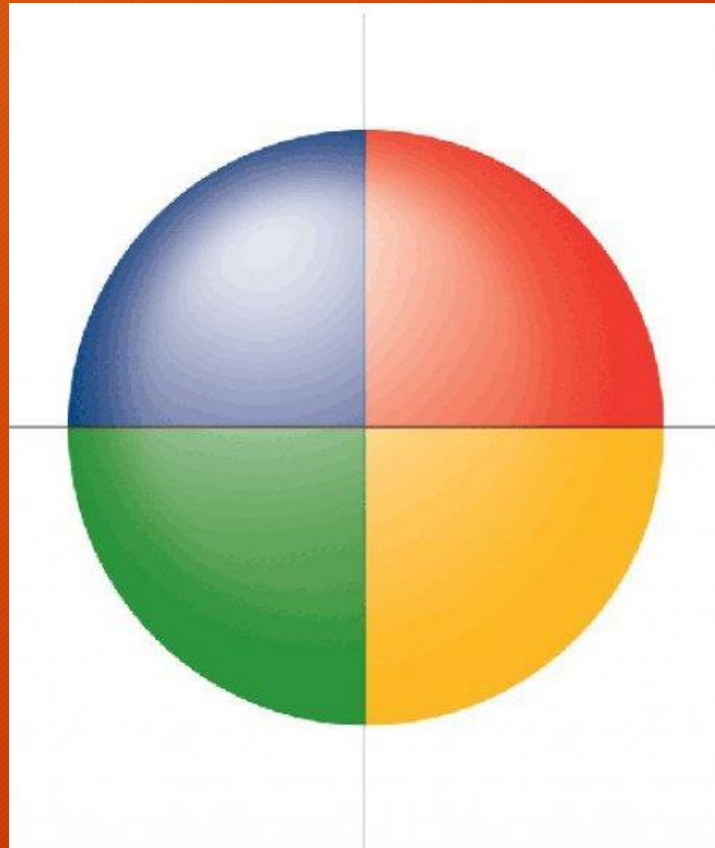
CIRCLE

Friendly
Nurturing
Persuasive
Empathetic
Generous
Stabilizing

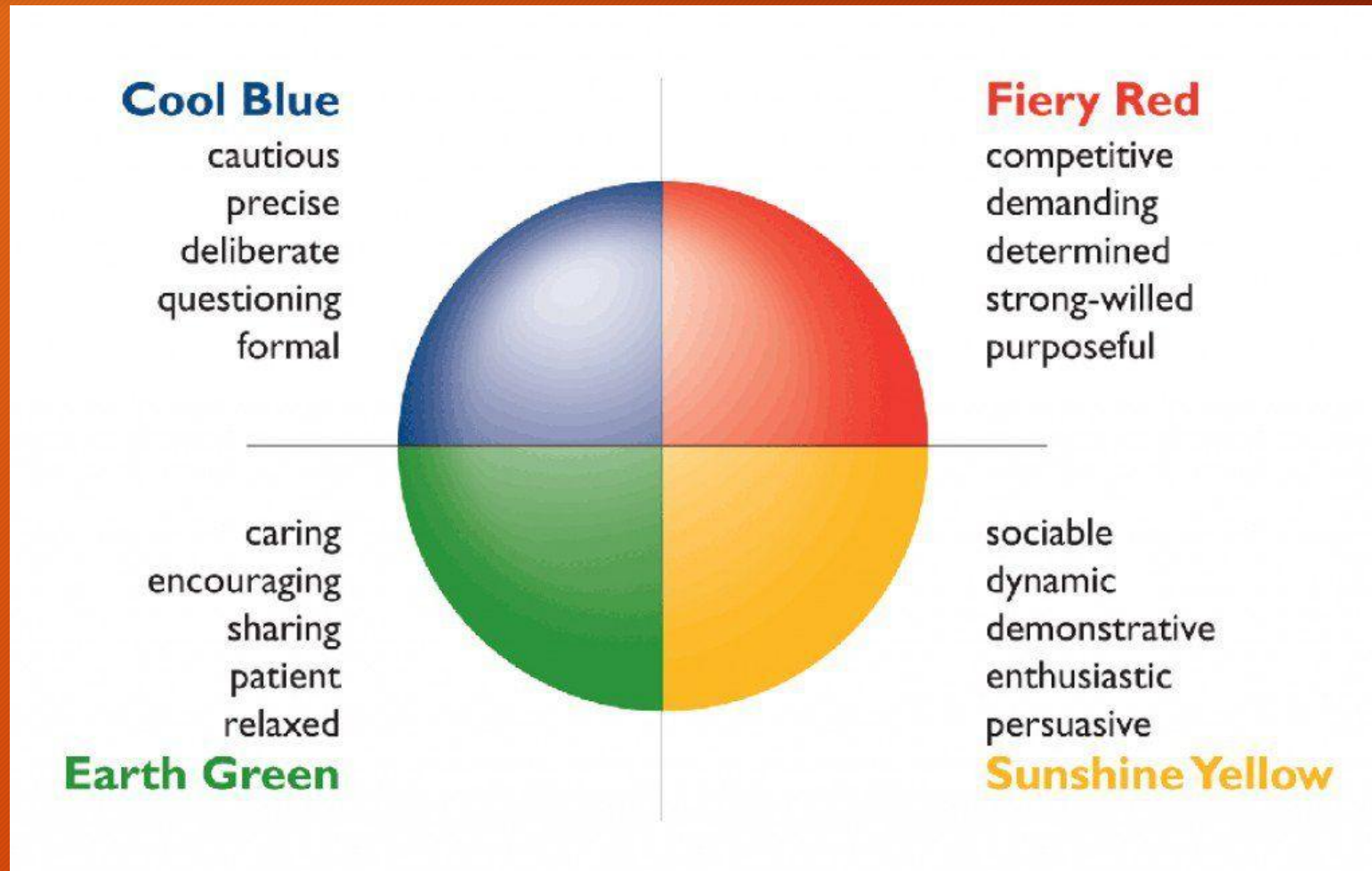
SQUIGGLE

Creative
Motivating
Futuristic
Intuitive
Expressive
Witty

Which do you like best and why?



Which do you like best and why?



Which do you like best and why?

- What do you think about the shapes and colours tests?
- Is all this bull-shit? If so, why?
- Why might it be useful?

TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)

TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)

- Can we actually classify personalities?
- What do you think the key “features” of personality are?
- Why might it be useful?
- [Personality Test of Myers & Briggs' 16 Types | TypeFinder® \(truity.com\)](https://truity.com)

TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)

Where do you
get your energy
from?

E

Extraversion

Prefer to get their energy
'externally': from activities and (a
lot of) interaction with people.

I

Introversion

Prefer to get their energy from
themselves, "internally": from
thoughts, feelings, ideas and some
time spent alone to recharge the

Which type of
information do
you prefer?

S

Sensing

Like to focus on information they
can actually perceive (details) and
on practical applications.

N

Intuition

Prefer to focus on patterns,
connections and possible meanings.

How do you
make a
decision?

T

Thinking

Prefer to base decisions on logic
and objective analysis of cause and
effect.

F

Feeling

Naturally consider what is
important to other people when
making decisions.

How do you
plan your life
and work?

J

Judging

Preference for living a planned and
organized life

P

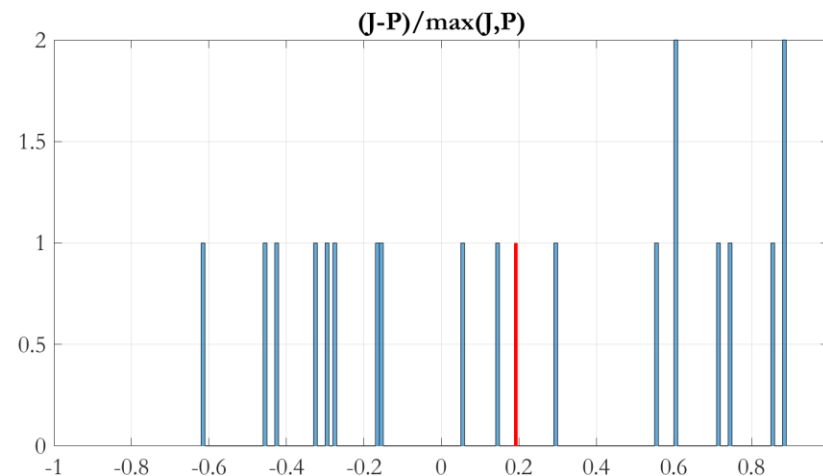
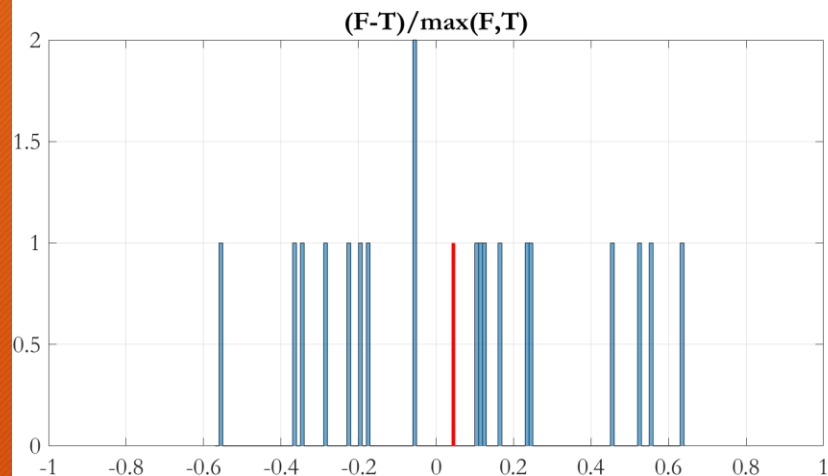
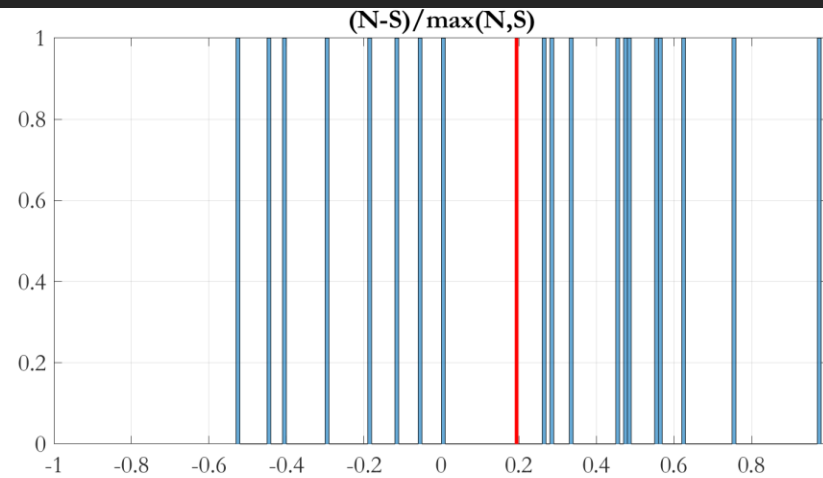
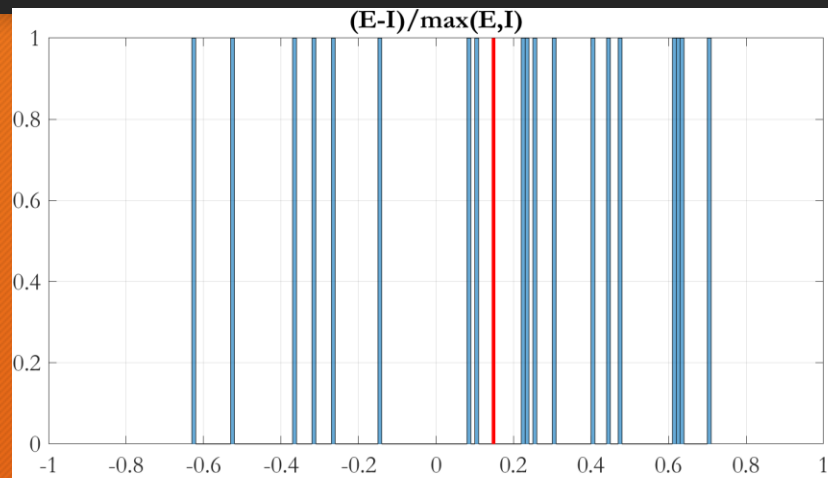
Perceiving

Like a flexible, spontaneous
approach and prefer to keep
options open.

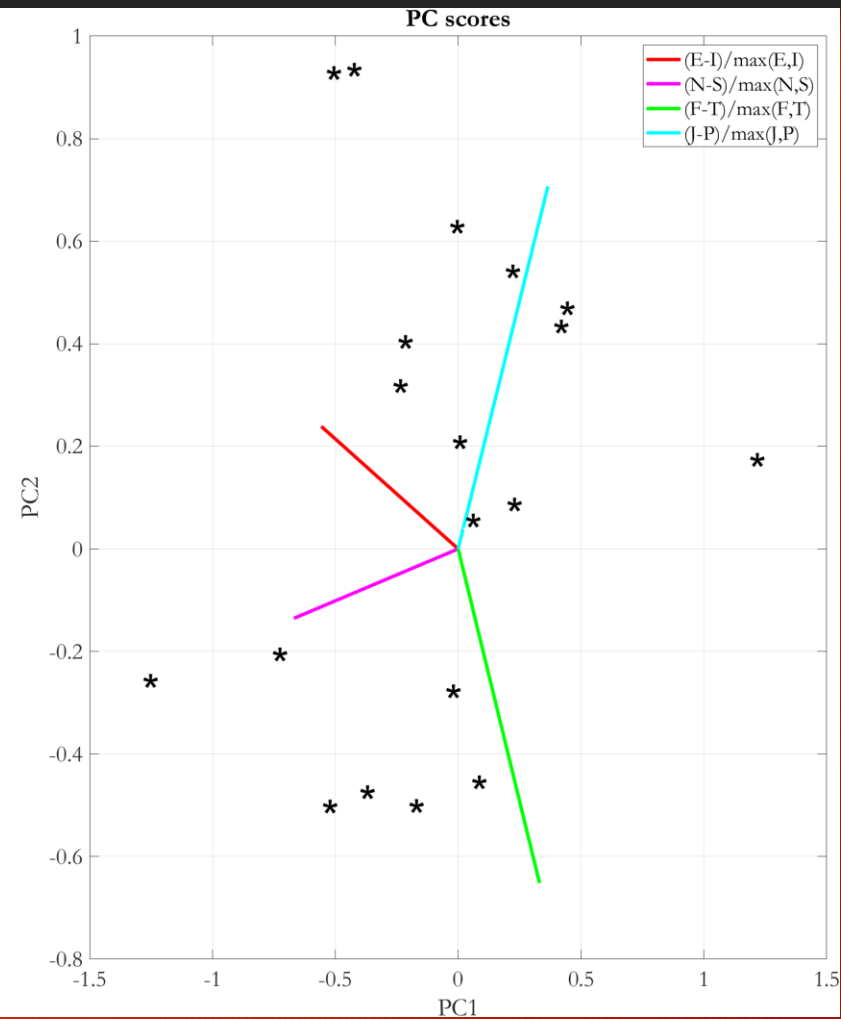
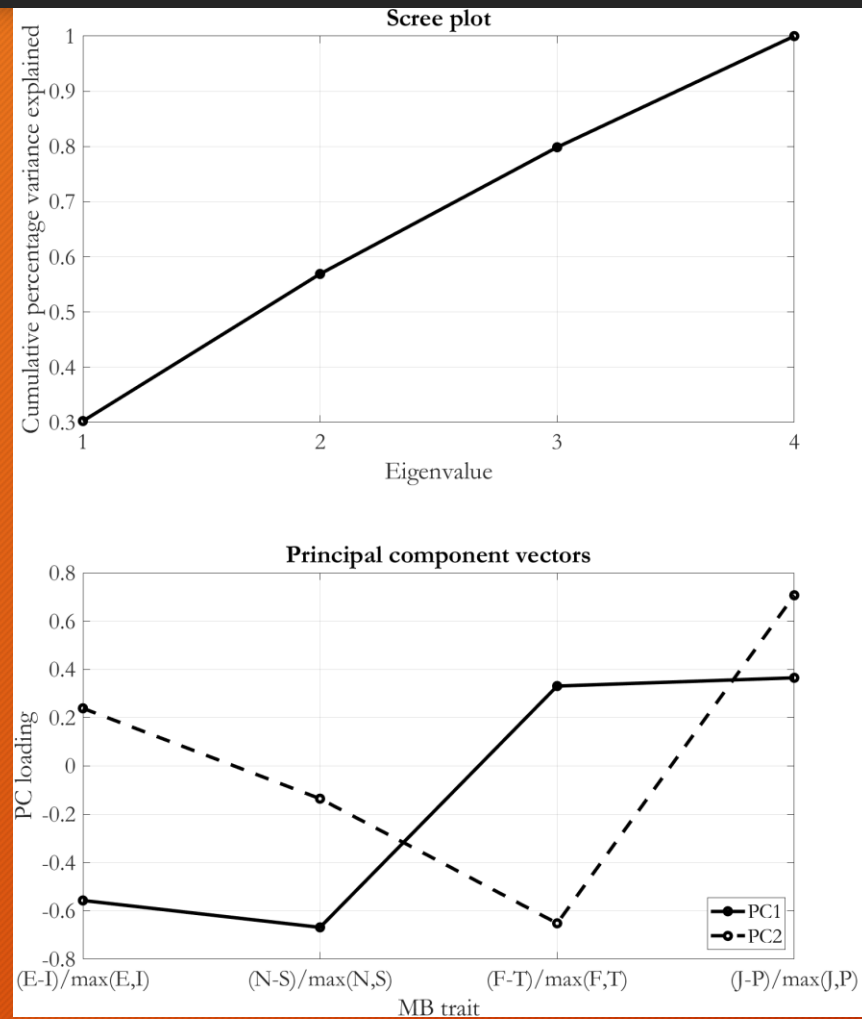
TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)

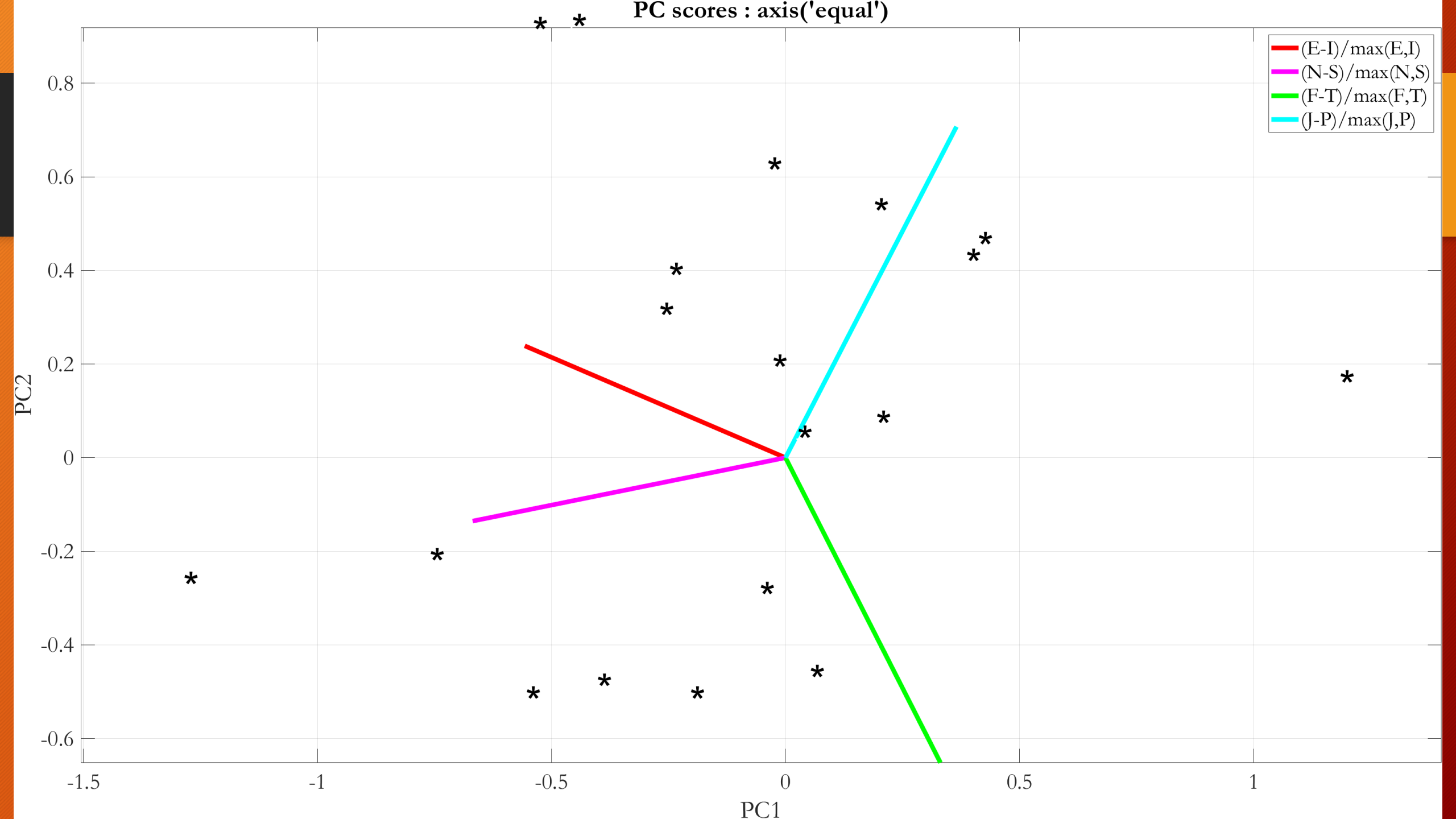
- 19 respondents
 - 12 students
 - 7 academic and admin staff
- Scaled difference for each trait
 - $(A-B)/\max(A,B)$
 - For each of (A,B) pairs (E,I), (N,S), (F,T) and (J,P)
- What do you think the answers will look like?
 - Do you think you're more like some folks than others?
- Remember this is a bit of fun, but there's logic behind it!

TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)



TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)





TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)

- Isabel Briggs Myers and her mother Katharine Briggs (US, in WW2)
- Over 50,000,000 official tests done
- What do you think?
- What does the analysis tell you about working with others?
 - Who is like you?
 - Who is different to you?
- Will you behave differently in future?

Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)

Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)

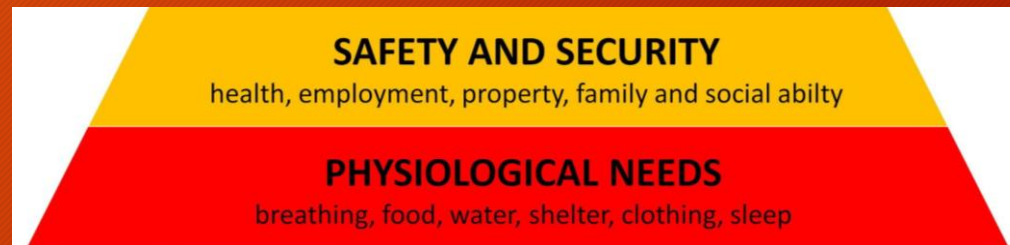
- Can we order our needs?
- Maslow's hierarchy goes from the most basic to the most advanced needs.
- Higher needs in the hierarchy begin to emerge when people feel they have sufficiently satisfied the previous need.
- What do you think the ordered components might be, from the most fundamental?

Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)

PHYSIOLOGICAL NEEDS

breathing, food, water, shelter, clothing, sleep

Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)



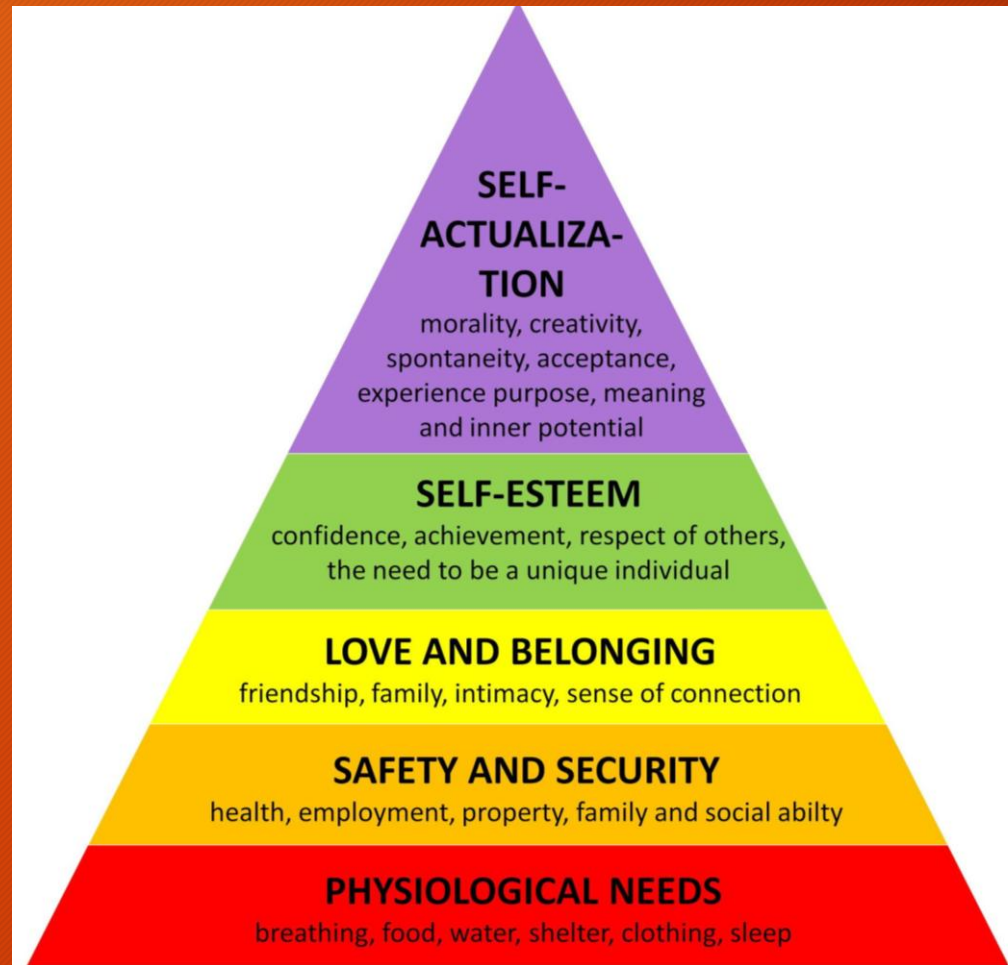
Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)



Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)



Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)



Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)

- Abraham Maslow (US, 1943; positive “humanist” psychologist)
- Comments?

Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)

Self-actualisation

- Truth: honest, reality, beauty, pure, clean and unadulterated completeness
- Goodness: rightness, desirability, uprightness, benevolence, honesty
- Beauty: rightness, form, aliveness, simplicity, richness, wholeness, perfection, completion,
- Wholeness: unity, integration, tendency to oneness, interconnectedness, simplicity, organization, structure, order, not dissociated, synergy
- Dichotomy-transcendence: acceptance, resolution, integration, polarities, opposites, contradictions
- Aliveness: process, not-deadness, spontaneity, self-regulation, full-functioning
- Uniqueness: idiosyncrasy, individuality, non comparability, novelty
- Perfection: nothing superfluous, nothing lacking, everything in its right place, just-rightness, suitability, justice
- Necessity: inevitability: it must be just that way, not changed in any slightest way
- Completion: ending, justice, fulfillment
- Justice: fairness, suitability, disinterestedness, non partiality,
- Order: lawfulness, rightness, perfectly arranged
- Simplicity: abstract, essential skeletal, bluntness
- Richness: differentiation, complexity, intricacy, totality
- Effortlessness: ease; lack of strain, striving, or difficulty
- Playfulness: fun, joy, amusement
- Self-sufficiency: autonomy, independence, self-determining

What can we really know and understand?

What can we really know and understand?

- How do you know you exist?

What can we really know and understand?

- How do you know you'll wake up tomorrow morning?

What can we really know and understand?

- Is there a God?

What can we really know and understand?

- Does the central limit theorem work everywhere in the universe?

What can we really know and understand?

- What happened before the Big Bang? Was there a Big Bang?

What can we really know and understand?

- Can you ever prove causality?

What can we really know and understand?

- What is free will?

What can we really know and understand?

- Is it OK to kill one person, if by doing so you avoid 10 people being killed?

What can we really know and understand?

- Is it OK to eat meat?

What can we really know and understand?

- Is it OK to work for an “oil company”, or a bank, or for “big tech”, or the Conservative Party?

What can we really know and understand?

- Why did so many people in the US support Donald Trump II for President?

What can we really know and understand?

- Is it OK to be spending your days studying for a PhD at Lancaster when you could be helping “save lives in Africa”?

What can we really know and understand?

- Many things are beyond our comprehension
- Many things are unanswerable
- Any estimates we make lean strongly on “our priors”
- Our different “nature” and “nurture” mean we can have quite different views on many topics to others
- No “right” or “wrong”, just “different”
- What does this mean for leadership?

What makes a “good” or “bad” leader?

What makes a “good” leader?

Clement Atlee	Managed the home front during WWII as deputy PM, created the welfare state as PM
Volodymyr Zelenskyy	Leads the defence of Ukraine against the Russian invasion (“I need ammunition, not a ride”)
Satoru Iwata	Listened to his employees (‘Iwata Asks’), led his company to great success
Vincent Kompany	Former footballer and captain of Manchester city. Strong and decisive on the pitch.
Francis Ford Coppola	Director. Managed to get the best out of notoriously difficult actors whilst also filming in some challenging locations and excelling.
My Mum	Teacher. Took an English department from struggling to consistently outstanding in a school which as a whole has consistently struggled to get out of special measures.
Martin Luther King Jr	Compassionate orator whose actions and message lead to mass positive change.
Martin Luther King Jr	It is important for a leader to be someone who you can look up to
Nobody	Flat hierarchies can work well if everyone is roughly equally motivated
Revolutionaries throughout the 20 th Century	Successfully motivated and organised people <u>en masse</u> to enact change and obtain political power (even if what they did with the power was awful; good leaders of movements need not be good people or good leaders of government)
Reed Hastings (Netflix)	Listened to an employee who thought it would be best to switch to a streaming service and it made the company very successful. It is good to listen to the people you are leading
Dan Price	His company Gravity Payments put a minimum salary of £70k for all employees. He chose to take a large <u>payout</u> to improve the lives of his workers. It is good to support the people you are leading
A former manager at my job	Worked as hard as anyone else on the team and always found time for 1 on 1 meetings despite her very tight schedule
Antoine Dupond	Amazing work ethic, level-headed and humble while fostering camaraderie
David Attenborough	Raised awareness and inspired people through his passion and dedication to safeguarding our planet
Jack Ma, founder of Alibaba	Jack Ma began as an English teacher, but he had really good visionary thinking ability as spotting the opportunity (bold idea) at a time when few believed in e-commerce. Good at gathering people with different skills
A former research project team leader	She ensured that everyone’s ideas were heard, set clear goals and expectations
Jon	In a small team challenge in away days activities. Good at dividing the jobs and get everyone involved
Band conductor #1	Was a really positive influence on members of the band. Proactive, enthusiastic and driving to push us forwards
Skating Coach #1	Really strove to make training interesting and innovative. Pushed to try new things to do something different to the standard. Very good listener and a source of positivity.

Part-time job evening manager	Treated staff with respect and often took part in the work, not afraid to be one of us and share responsibilities. A caring and empathetic person, who treated everyone with respect.
Jon	
Idris	
My parents	
Gareth Southgate	Felt like he worked to get to the 'leader' position as England manager - ex-player -> U21 coach -> senior coach. Then when he came in, he setup/talked to the youth network throughout England, for a <u>long term</u> goal. When things went badly on the pitch, he didn't blame his players in the public (as far as I can remember). So good, as he was willing to get everyone involved towards a common goal, and when things didn't go <u>well</u> he takes the blame
Greta Thunberg	Lead’ children to strike, named “school strike for Climate”, using Social media to do this and lead to students in multiple countries to join in. I wouldn’t say she’s the most charismatic but must have been the spark that lit the <u>flame</u> so people were willing to get behind her
Martin Luther King	Charismatic leader getting people to join his cause through his famous “I Have a dream speech”, as well as many other things. Uses Charisma to get people to rally behind him
Eleanor D’Arcy	Very organised at leading the extremes reading group, did a lot of work but made it seem easy.
Computer Science teacher	Adapted things to suit everybody, put in extra effort
Alexander the Great	Never lost a battle and fought in them himself
Lina Khan	Chair of the US Federal Trade Commission 2021-2025. I think she was a good leader because she had clear goals and the strategy to back it up
Anna Wintour	Editor in chief of Vogue, and leader chair of the Met Gala. Ambitious, surrounds herself with the right people. Willing to be controversial but keeps her head above it all
Shonda Rhimes	Writer and producer of many successful TV shows, including Greys Anatomy and Bridgerton. Very deliberate and careful about who she delegates too, strikes a good balance between innovation and keeping what’s reliable going.
Caroline Lucas	Down to earth and in touch with subordinates
Angela Merkel	Acts according to objective analysis and reason
Gareth Southgate	Knows how to deal with failure

What makes a “bad” leader?

Liz Truss	crashed the economy, poor management of her parliamentary party
Liz Truss	A misguided leader who struggled to take control and led to economic and political turmoil
Liz Truss	
Nero	burned people alive, possibly caused big fire, removed from power by other elites
Denethor II, son of Ecthelion II	corrupted by a palantír , actively sabotages the defence of his nation
Pol Pot	Poor leadership and ideas and desire for control lead to dire consequences
Tony Smith	Rugby league coach of Hull FC during its worst playing period of my life. Poor at maintaining discipline and consistency and couldn't control the team
Elon Musk	Micromanaging, credit-thieving
Elon Musk	Authoritarian and fear-based leadership, leading to negative consequences for employee morale and well-being
2 nd Year Undergrad group project	Closest thing we had to a leader, managed to fall out with everyone except for me. Sharp-tongued, changed people's work without asking or discussing, etc.
Boris Yeltsin	Drunk, incompetent, led his country to total impoverishment
Kodak Management	A Kodak engineer invented the first digital camera in 1975 and presented it to management, but Kodak didn't think it would be wanted by people and the company failed. These leaders were bad leaders because they didn't listen
Equifax Management	A credit company that got hacked and leaked data of over 145 million people. A security researcher outlined issues prior to the incident and were ignored
Boeing Management	"an expert panel found a "disconnect" between senior management and regular staff, as well as signs that staff were hesitant about reporting problems for fear of retaliation." https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/business-68573686
Elizabeth Holmes	She misled investors and the public, showing how dishonesty in leadership can have serious consequences
A former supervisor	Showed no interest in other people's work and provided no guidance when necessary
A student group leader	During a university project they didn't resolve conflicts among team members
A previous internship manager	Poor communication, a lack of planning led to confusion among team members
A language exchange group organiser	Often arrived late or unprepared, which led to wasted time and frustration among participants

Band conductor #2	Had a high opinion of themselves. Wasn't willing to put in the time or effort to do what was best for the band. Very closed-minded
Part-time job general manager	Did not listen to the concerns of staff. Unwilling to compromise and believed that a position of leadership entitled them to treat staff as lesser people
Skating coach # 2	Believed that frustration and negativity is a good motivator for productive training, ruling by fear. Made the training environment not an enjoyable place to be
My friend's work boss	
Managers from Office Space (1999 movie)	
Richard the Lionheart	Spent most of the treasury to go on crusades, leaving unequipped brother in charge. Shirking responsibility of looking after the country and people he is meant to overseeing.
Julius Ceasar	Can't be too good of a leader if you are unaware of an assassination plot happening within the people who 'work' for you. Likely, out of touch with his employees
Jerry Yang	Founder of Yahoo, CEO when he rejected a bid from Microsoft to buy Yahoo for \$47 billion in 2008. Lead to thousands of Layoffs and company never got back to that level of success + value again. Overvalued his own company (or was too proud) leading to major downfall of the company and resulted in lost jobs
Manager	Didn't communicate well, unfair, would prioritise her son
Sixth Form head	Prioritised only some students, mostly interested in making herself look good
Douglas Haig	WW1 field marshal, didn't adapt battle strategy to new technologies
Basically everyone running the US government right now	Unfocused, no achievable goals, grandstanding for ego purposes rather than actual beneficial purposes
Boris Johnson	Does not practice what he preaches
Donald Trump	Does not act in long-term best interest

What makes a “good” or “bad” leader?

- Thoughts?
- Do you think you would make a good leader?
 - Why?
 - Why not?

What are the key leadership traits?

What are the key leadership traits?



What are the key leadership traits?



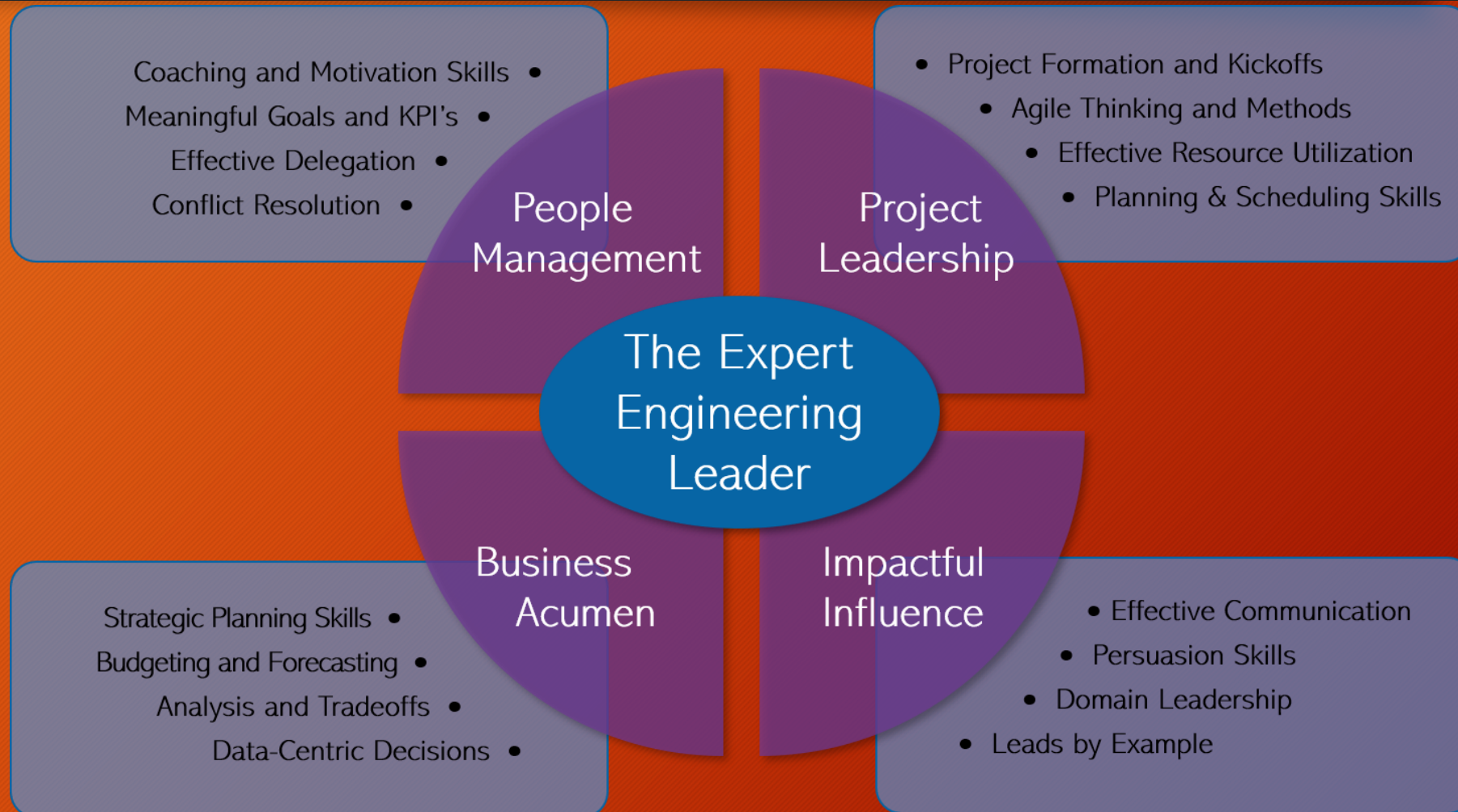
What is leadership meant to achieve?

What is leadership meant to achieve?



The Expert
Engineering
Leader

What is leadership meant to achieve?



What is leadership like in practice?

What is leadership like in practice?

- Leadership styles
- Key things to get right?
- What typically goes wrong?
- Coping strategies for leadership stress

Leadership styles

Leadership styles

DEFINITION

A leadership style encompasses the leader's behaviors, attitudes, and actions in influencing and directing others towards achieving common goals. Different leadership styles exist, ranging from autocratic to democratic, and can vary in terms of decision-making authority, communication style, level of involvement, and focus on relationship building.

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A leadership style encompasses the leader's behaviors, attitudes, and actions in influencing and directing others towards achieving common goals. Different leadership styles exist, ranging from autocratic to democratic, and can vary in terms of decision-making authority, communication style, level of involvement, and focus on relationship building.

EXAMPLES

- Autocratic leadership
- Democratic leadership
- Transformational leadership
- Transactional leadership
- Laissez-faire leadership
- Servant leadership
- Charismatic leadership
- Bureaucratic leadership
- Situational leadership
- Coaching leadership

Key things to get right?

Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best

Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
 - Work in a way that is most fun for you, “generating energy”
 - Adopt your optimal leadership and working style
 - Be a black hole for the rubbish, but radiate the good stuff around!
 - Wear a “yes face”

Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals

Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals
 - Walk the talk - practice what you preach - behave the way you want your team to behave
 - Be as honest and open with the team as possible
 - Work for the best interests of the whole team, even the ones you find it harder to get along with
 - "Work with and through others"

Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals
- “Own” the key success factors for your team

Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals
- “Own” the key success factors for your team
 - Take responsibility for setting success factors that work for all “stakeholders”
 - Take responsibility to ensure these are achieved
 - Be the “external face” of the team
 - Be the “gap-filler” and “glue” of the team

Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals
- “Own” the key success factors for your team
- Keep your colleagues happy

Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals
- “Own” the key success factors for your team
- Keep your colleagues happy
 - Help your team members be ready and able to contribute at their best
 - Make sure you team has enough work to do
 - Manage individual performance of team members
 - Recruitment and retention for team
 - Facilitate “next steps” for team members (outside the team)
 - Training and mentoring for team

What typically goes wrong?

What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?

What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
 - People have different abilities and needs
 - One person's "dream project" can be a "mill stone" for another
 - Your leadership style might naturally favour some team members
 - Finding the right balance is tricky ... it's all "observer dependent"

What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors

What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors
 - Bureaucracy
 - “HR rules”
 - “Reorganisation”
 - “Events, my dear boy, events” (Harold Macmillan, UK PM 1957-1963)

What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors
- Irreconcilable differences

What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors
- Irreconcilable differences
 - Under-performing staff
 - Unwillingness to compromise

What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors
- Irreconcilable differences
- Personal workload

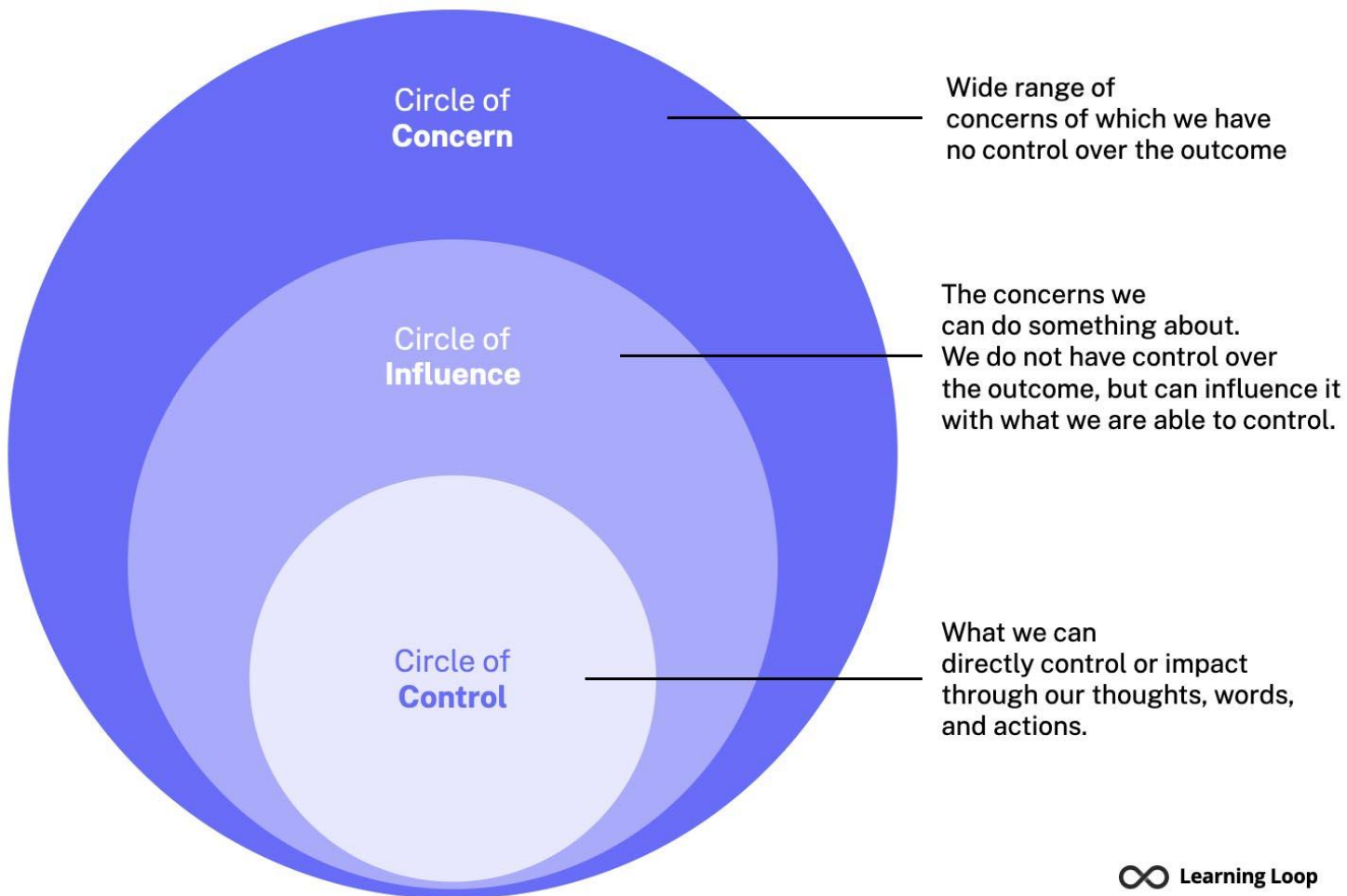
What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors
- Irreconcilable differences
- Personal workload
 - “Victim of own success”
 - Failure to delegate
 - Over-commitment to projects and people

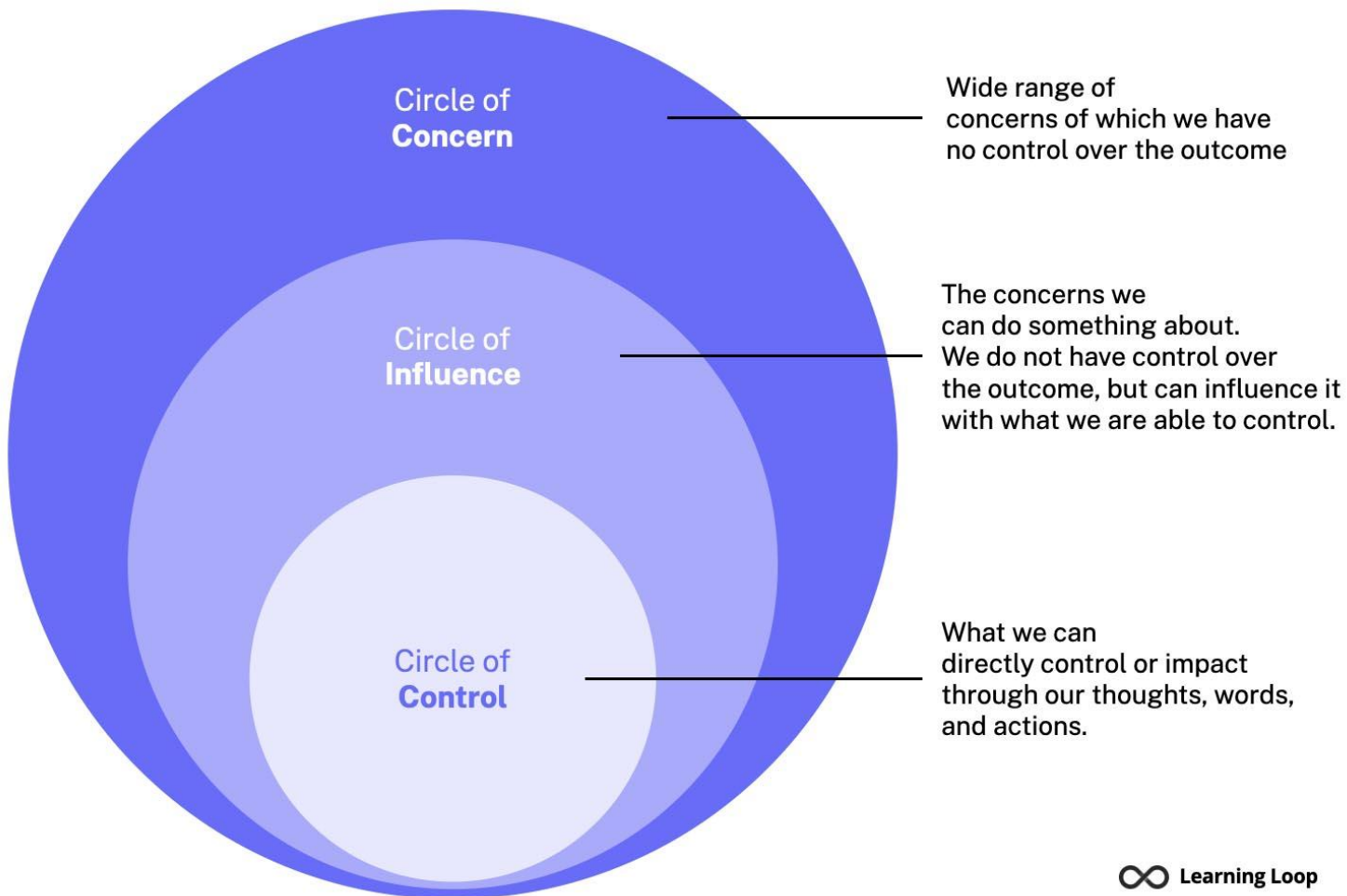
Coping strategies for leadership stress

- A sense of perspective

Coping strategies for leadership stress



Coping strategies for leadership stress



Wellbeing and your belief system



Coping strategies for leadership stress

- A sense of perspective
 - Spheres of control, influence and concern
 - Be faithful to your “belief system”
 - Remember: it’s just a job

Coping strategies for leadership stress

- A sense of perspective
- A safe space, and trusted people to talk to

Coping strategies for leadership stress

- A sense of perspective
- A safe space, and trusted people to talk to
 - A senior colleague “who’s seen it all before”
 - Share your concerns openly

Coping strategies for leadership stress

- A sense of perspective
- A safe space, and trusted people to talk to
- Don't give up on the good stuff

Coping strategies for leadership stress

- A sense of perspective
- A safe space, and trusted people to talk to
- Don't give up on the good stuff
 - There's a tendency to sacrifice the “fun” stuff when under pressure; this is exactly the wrong thing to do!
 - Hobbies, sports, friends and relationships

To “be” and “work” best for myself and others?



Have a sense
of wonder.



Stay inspired.



Help others.



Do things you're
good at.



Read books.



Limit television.



Love your work.



Exercise.



Face your fears.



Believe in yourself.



Stay close to
friends and family.



Let your heart
be your guide.





Take-aways

- Leadership is art (or at best soft science), not maths or physics

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- Leadership is art (or at best soft science), not maths or physics
 - So don't expect rigour!
 - Soft skills are important

Take-aways

- Leadership is art (or at best soft science), not maths or physics
- There are basic concepts it's good to know about

Take-aways

- Leadership is art (or at best soft science), not maths or physics
- There are basic concepts it's good to know about
 - Most of these are “common sense”
 - But knowing the terminology and frameworks used is good as a basis for rational learning and communication
 - A Management School can give you chapter and verse!

Take-aways

- Leadership is art (or at best soft science), not maths or physics
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- We all exercise leadership skills all the time

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Take-aways

- Leadership is art (or at best soft science), not maths or physics
- There are basic concepts it's good to know about
- We all exercise leadership skills all the time
- If you take a “leadership role” in your work life:
 - It can be fun and rewarding
 - Take it seriously, but not too seriously
 - Try to do the best for everyone in your team without exception
 - Look around and identify the leaders you respect most, and learn from them; but most of all, be true to yourself
 - Keep doing the fun stuff